SHASHA TIAN

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RESEARCH INTEREST

Shasha Tian's recent work uses large-scale mobility and user-generated data to examine how spatial structures and human mobility jointly shape **unequal** access to opportunities and environmental exposure. Her earlier research training on **environment and transportation** first developed the statistical and spatial-analytical foundations that now underlie her AI-enabled, data-driven approach.

EDUCATION

M.Eng. in Urban Planning *Shanghai, China*
Tongji University (2025 QS Ranking by Subject: 11) *Sept 2021 — Sept 2024*
Honors: Recipient of Graduate Scholarship (CNY 8000)
Thesis: Planning Practices for Low-Carbon Villages: Evidence from Three Villages in Zhejiang Province

M.Sc. in Urban Planning and Policy Design (Double-degree Program) *Milan, Italy*
Polytechnic University of Milan (2025 QS Ranking by Subject: 7) *Sept 2022 — Oct 2023*
Thesis: Low Carbon Village Planning Principles and Practice

B.Sc. in Human Geography and Urban-Rural Planning *Guangzhou, China*
Sun Yat-sen University (2025 ARWU GRAS: 17) *Aug 2017 — June 2021*
Honors: Recipient of Undergraduate Scholarship (CNY 3000)
Selected Course (Max 100)**:** Advanced Mathematics (94) | Linear Algebra (94) | GIS Database (95.6)
Data Structure (90) | Logic Programming (91) | Probability and Statistics (96)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

From Residential Segregation to Dining Segregation: Evidence from Restaurant Visits in U.S. Cities
Research Assistant, with Prof. Songhua HU, City University of Hong Kong *June 2026 — Present*

Analyzing mobility data (SafeGraph) and restaurant information (Google Maps) to quantify income-based residential and dining segregation; employing a fractional logit model to examine the effects of MSA, CBG, restaurant characteristics, cuisine types, and service formats on segregation indices.

Mobility-Weighted Park Exposure and Residential Segregation in New York City
Project Collaborator, with Dr. Mingze CHEN, Postdoctoral Associate at MIT *Aug 2026 — Present*

Analyzing mobility data (Advan) across 6,397 NYC census block groups to compute visit-weighted park exposure and racial homophily; detecting community structure through modularity-based network clustering to assess whether mobility reproduces or amplifies residential segregation.

Urban AI Research and Applications
Research Fellow, AIGC Lab, Shanghai Planning and Research Institute *Dec 2024 — Mar 2026*

Tourist Review Analysis: Scraping Tripadvisor reviews, leveraging NLP techniques including co-occurrence networks, sentiment analysis and topic modeling to analyze travel behavior, emotional preferences, and site evaluations, thus delivering visitor profiles and data-driven planning strategies.

Xingkong Urban Knowledge App Knowledge Curation & Evaluation:

Built a three-level taxonomy of planning scale, type, and subtype; curated high-quality planning cases, authored QA pairs, and evaluated model outputs for accuracy and relevance, supporting the publicly available Xingkong mobile application.

Transportation Network Analysis and Passenger Travel Decision-Making Modeling
Earlier Research Training, with Prof. Suhong ZHOU, Sun Yat-sen University *Feb 2019 — July 2020*

Passenger Travel Decision-Making Modeling: Scraping schedule information of long-distance buses and high-speed train services with Python; examining how travel environment factors influence passenger travel preferences using a structural equation model (SEM).

Road Network Analysis: Employing space syntax to calculate the accessibility of the networks; computing Pearson correlation coefficients between POI density and network accessibility.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Research on the Spatiotemporal Evolution Patterns and Influencing Factors of Forest Fires in China
Earlier Research Training, with Prof. Ming LUO, Sun Yat-sen University *Sept 2018 — Feb 2019*

Utilizing the ArcGIS analysis toolkit and machine learning methods to process wildfire data alongside physical geographical and socioeconomic attribute data, revealing the spatiotemporal patterns and influencing factors of wildfires in China.

PUBLICATION

Shaojian Wang†, Shasha Tian, et al. 2021. "**Driving Factors and Carbon Transfer of Industrial Carbon Emissions in Guangdong Province under the Background of Industrial Transfer** ↗**.**" *Geographical Research* 40, no. 09: 2606–2622. † Supervisor.

Applying the material balance method to calculate carbon emissions; utilizing structural decomposition analysis to identify key factors driving carbon emissions.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & TALKS

From Residential Segregation to Dining Segregation: Evidence from Restaurant Visits in U.S. Cities. *International Conference on Urban Affairs (ICUA), New York, NY, USA* *Apr 2027*
(Forthcoming, see RESEARCH EXPERIENCE)

Monitoring Sustainable Urban Public Life through Image-based Activity. *Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference, Pittsburgh, PA, USA.* *Oct 2026*

From Voice to Vision, from Language to Landscape, NLP Empowers Urban Planning. Internal Seminar, Shanghai Planning and Research Institute, *Shanghai, China.* *Oct 2025*
(Based on the "Tourist Perception" project, see RESEARCH EXPERIENCE)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Carbon Finance Research Intern, *Industrial Bank (Fortune Global 500)* *Aug 2024 — Nov 2024*

Carbon Disclosure Support: Assisting in preparing corporate ESG reports, ensuring consistency with International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS) Sustainability Disclosure Standards.

Environmental Analyst Intern, *Deloitte* *Feb 2024 — Mar 2024*

Corporate Assessment: Calculating corporate environmental performance using API-based data, applying weighted indicator models and normalization methods for cross-firm comparison.

Index Construction: Developing a risk control indicator system using methods such as Principal Component Analysis (PCA), and scenario-based stress testing to quantify exposure and resilience.

Market Research Analyst Intern, *China Overseas Property Holdings Limited* *June 2021 — July 2021*

Market Research: Monitoring sales performance and reassessing marketing strategies.

AWARDS & GRANTS

Distinction Award	**2025 Fuxing Island Global Design Competition**	*2025*
3rd Prize	**"Yangtze River Delta 2049: Our AI Home" Creative Competition** (Based on the "Fuxing Island" Project, see TALKS)	*2025*
Best Debater	**City Development Strategy and Policy Debate Competition**	*2022*
Nomination Award	**International Competition on Urban Sustainability Reports**	*2021*
3rd Prize	**Natural Resources Science and Technology Competition** (Based on the "Forest Fires" Project, see RESEARCH EXPERIENCE)	*2019*
CNY 3,000 Grant	**Innovation Training Project** (Based on the "Road Network"Project, see RESEARCH EXPERIENCE)	*2019*

SKILLS

Software: *ArcGIS, ENVI, Photoshop, Premiere*
Coding: *C++, Python, Prolog*

LANGUAGE

English: *Fluent (IELTS 7.5)*
Mandarin: *Native*